

Conversation

#04

CONVERSATION

TRAVEL & HOSPITALITY – Hotels and Reservations

The hotel industry has changed a lot over the past few years. With remote work, digital nomads, and flexible travel on the rise, people are booking stays for everything from weekend escapes to full-on “workations.” Hotels have had to keep up—offering mobile check-in, app-based room service, high-speed Wi-Fi, and coworking lounges right next to the pool.

Even with all these upgrades, things can still go sideways. A double booking, a name entered wrong in the system, or a fully booked hotel with no backup plan can turn a relaxing trip into a stressful mess. These situations happen more often than you’d think, and being able to explain clearly and stay calm can make a huge difference.

Picture this: you land in Miami for a conference after a long flight. You’re tired, hungry, and just want to take a hot shower. But when you get to the front desk, they say they can’t find your reservation. After a few phone calls and some digging, they realize your name was entered incorrectly during booking. Luckily, they offer you a **suite upgrade** and free breakfast as a way to make it up to you. Not ideal, but at least they handled it professionally.

In cases like this, how you communicate matters. Hotel staff are trained to solve problems, but being polite and direct goes a long way. Expressions like “Would you mind checking again?” or “Could you connect me with a manager?” can help you get better service without sounding rude. And if you’re on a business trip, it doesn’t hurt to mention that it’s being put **on the company card**—some places will take extra care when they know a company’s involved.

Technology is also changing how we interact with hotels. A lot of people now check in through apps, use digital keys, and even order room service via chatbot. It’s fast and convenient—but not everyone is a fan of the impersonal vibe. Because of that, many hotels now offer hybrid options, blending digital convenience with old-school customer service. Whether you’re a solo traveler or part of a team retreat, hotels are learning to meet people where they are.

One of the biggest trends in travel is what people are calling “bleisure”—mixing business and leisure. Someone flies in for meetings on Thursday and stays through the weekend to relax. Hotels are catching on, offering things like early check-in, wellness classes, and quiet zones for video calls. The best ones feel just as good for a work trip as they do for a vacation.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS:

- 1 - Have you ever had an issue at a hotel (bad service, no booking, poor conditions, etc.)? What happened?
- 2 - What’s the best or most unique place you’ve ever stayed in? What made it special?
- 3 - What do you think the hotels of the future should offer to guests?
- 4 - Would you rather stay in a hotel or use a service like Airbnb? Why?
- 5 - What do you look for when booking a place to stay—price, location, reviews, amenities?

At least three hotel-related terms or expressions (e.g. “fully booked,” “suite upgrade,” “no-show”) Your personal opinion about how staying in hotels has changed in recent years.

Title: _____

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